

Qiang (Steven) Wu

Department of Political Science

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(Updated September 24, 2026)

Education

Texas A&M University – Bush School of Government & Public Service

Ph.D. in Political Science, August 2026, College Station, TX

- Major: **International Relations**
- Minor: **Comparative Politics & Political Methodology**
- **Dissertation:** *Contesting the Liberal Order? Chinese Economic Statecraft, Alternative Institutions, and the Diffusion of Governance Norms*
- **Committee:** Matthew Fuhrmann (Chair), Hyeran Jo (Co-Chair), Matt Malis, David Bearce.

Johns Hopkins University – School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS)

M.A. in International Economics & China Studies, Specialization in Economic Policy, Dean's Scholarship, 2020, Washington, DC

Kyoto University – Graduate School of Economics

M.A. in Economics, Japan Development Scholarship (JDS Scholar), Fully Funded by JICA, 2014, Kyoto, Japan

Peking University – School of International Studies

M.A. in International Relations (Great Power Politics and Diplomacy), 2012, Beijing, China

Peking University – School of Government

B.A. in Political Science & Public Administration, 2004, Beijing, China

Academic Appointments

University at Albany, SUNY, Adjunct Lecturer in Political Science, August 2026–Present

Publications and Research in Progress

Published Working Paper

- **Wu, Qiang.** “*Foreign Aid and Leadership Support in Informal International Institutions: Evidence from China–Africa Cooperation, 2000–2024.*” *AidData Working Paper* No. 145. Williamsburg, VA: AidData at William & Mary.

Editor-Reviewed Paper

- **Wu, Qiang.** 2020. “*China’s Use of Trade Retaliation in Territorial Disputes: Interdependence with a Difficult but Rational Power.*” *SAIS China Studies Review*, Volume 6

Working Papers

- **Wu, Qiang.** “*Asymmetric Interdependence and Security Reassurance under Great Power Rivalry: China Dependence and U.S.-Involved Joint Military Exercises in the Indo-Pacific, 1992–2016*”
- **Wu, Qiang.** “*Output Legitimacy Beyond Borders: Does Chinese Development Finance Diffuse Its Model in Africa?*”
- **Wu, Qiang,** Kyung Suk Lee, Kirby Goidel, and Clifford Young. “*Income, Populism, Nativism, and Partisanship: How Interests and Ideologies Shape Attitudes Toward Trade and Globalization.*”
- **Wu, Qiang** and Quan Li. “*Cold War, Democratization and the Move to Free Trade in the Developing Countries*”

Policy Essay

- **Wu, Qiang.** 2020. “*Time to Retrieve the First Heart of Multilateralism.*” *The Bretton Woods Committee.*

Book Project

- Invited book project on U.S.–China relations and Indo-Pacific dynamics, Palgrave Macmillan (invitation following an APSA 2024 presentation).

Policy Experience

- **Policy Aide to Committee Chair Li Zhaoxing (former Foreign Minister) and Vice Chair Ma Wenpu, Foreign Affairs Committee, National People’s Congress, China (2014–2017; 2007–2012)**
 - Legislation and Policy. Drafted foreign policy–related legislation and reports, including analysis of how China’s international treaty obligations apply to Hong Kong and Macau; drafted a border-infrastructure proposal for the Belt and Road Initiative that was incorporated into **China’s 13th Five-Year Plan** (2016–2020).
- **Policy Communication Strategist, Annual Plenary Sessions of the National People’s Congress, China (2014–2017)**
 - Produced public communication materials on economy, Taiwan/Hong Kong/Macau issues, and foreign policy.

- **Parliamentary Diplomacy Consultant, National People's Congress, China (2007-2012)**
– Advised Chinese Congress delegations to the Chamber of Deputies (Rome, 2011) and State Duma (Moscow, 2010); supported hosting parliamentary delegations from the European Parliament, Australia, Russia, Iran, and Cambodia.
- **Selected Policy Writing in Chinese**
– **Wu, Qiang.** 2011. “Wei renmin fuwu zai renshi” [Reconsidering the Relationship between Government and People]. *Ziguang Ge (Policy Journal of the Central Government)*: 90–91.
– **Wu, Qiang.** 2010. “Zhonghua wenming youshi wuzhong” [The History and Future of Chinese Civilization]. *Outstanding Articles in the Congress Staff Essay Contest*. Beijing: National People's Congress.
– **Wu, Qiang.** 2009. “Dui minzhu de sikao” [Thoughts on Democracy]. *Outstanding Articles in the Congress Staff Essay Contest*. Beijing: China Democracy and Law Press.

Conferences & Workshops

Conferences

- **Wu, Qiang,** “*Foreign Aid and Leadership Support in Informal International Institutions: Evidence from China–Africa Cooperation.*”
– APSA Annual Meeting, 2026 (Panel organizer)
- **Wu, Qiang.** “*Money Yes, Friend No: How U.S. Allies and Partners Balance Economic Dependence on China and Security Cooperation with the United States.*”
– APSA Annual Meeting, 2025 (Invited panelist)
- **Wu, Qiang.** “*Economic Dependence and Security Cooperation with a Third-Party Great Power: The Case of the Indo-Pacific.*”
– APSA Annual Meeting, 2024; MPSA Annual Conference, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang** and Quan Li. “*Cold War, Democratization, and the Move to Free Trade in Developing Countries.*”
– APSA Annual Meeting, 2023; ISA Annual Convention, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang,** Kyung Suk Lee, Kirby Goidel, and Clifford Young. “*Globalization, International Trade, and Immigration: Perceptions and Realities.*”
– SPSA Annual Meeting, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang,** Quan Li, and Nehemia Geva. “*Do Trade Partners' Trade Practices Affect American Public Preferences on Trade Policy? When and How?*”
– ISA Annual Convention, 2024; MPSA Annual Conference, 2022; ISPP Annual Meeting, 2022

Workshops & Symposia

- **Wu, Qiang,** “*Output Legitimacy Beyond Borders: Does Chinese Development Finance Diffuse Its Model in Africa?*”
– Junior Fellows Convening, Institute for Humane Studies, 2026
- **Wu, Qiang,** “*Foreign Aid and Leadership Support in Informal International Institutions: Evidence from China–Africa Cooperation.*”
– Job Market Papers Workshop, Institute for Humane Studies, 2026

- **Wu, Qiang**, Kyung Suk Lee, Kirby Goidel, and Clifford Young. “*Income, Populism, Nativism, and Partisanship: How Interests and Ideologies Shape Attitudes Toward Trade and Globalization.*”
– Graduate Conference for the Social Sciences (2026), Contemporary Challenges in Trade Workshop I & II (2025), Institute for Humane Studies
- **Wu, Qiang**. “*How Economic Dependence on China Shapes U.S. Allies and Partners’ Security Relations with the United States: The Case of the Indo-Pacific.*”
– Trade Papers Workshop, Institute for Humane Studies (hosted at Harvard University), 2024; Junior Scholars Symposium, Cato Institute, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang**. “*Economy and Security in International Relations.*”
– Academy for Future Faculty, Texas A&M University, 2024
- **Wu, Qiang** and Quan Li. “*Does Sino-U.S. Strategic Rivalry Lead to Economic Rivalry in the Indo-Pacific Region?*”
– Taiwan-America Conference on Contemporary China, National Chengchi University, 2021

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

Fellowships

- **Junior Fellows Program**, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), Summer 2026 (\$7,000)
- **Graduate Fellowship**, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), 2025–2026 (\$8,000)
- **Junior Scholar**, Carnegie International Policy Scholars Consortium and Network (IPSCON), Kissinger Center, Johns Hopkins SAIS, 2024–2025 (about 20 scholars selected annually)
– Selected as one of approximately 20 junior scholars annually; Includes Foreign Policy Retreat, Minnowbrook, NY; Foreign Policy Workshop, Washington, DC; Carnegie Square Lectures, on-line
- **Humane Studies Fellowship**, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), 2024–2025 (\$5,000)
- **Program Fellow**, Foreign Policy Impact Summer Institute (First Cohort of 10 Fellows), Colorado State University, 2025 (\$3,000)

Honors

- **First Place**, Business and Political Science Section (Graduate), Student Research Week, Texas A&M University, 2023
- **Second Place**, [Henry Owen Memorial Award](#), Bretton Woods Committee, 2020
- **First Prize** (2010) and **Second Prize** (2009), National People's Congress Staff Essay Contest.

Grants

- Research Grant, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University, 2024 (\$1,500), 2023 (\$1,500), 2022 (\$1,500), 2021 (\$1,000)
- Methods Training Grant, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University, 2025. (\$1,500).

- Travel Grant, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University, 2022–2024; Institute for Humane Studies, 2023–2026; ISA, 2024; Cato Institute, 2023; National Chengchi University, 2021

Scholarships

- Dean’s Scholarship, Johns Hopkins SAIS, 2019–2020 (\$12,500)
- JDS Scholarship, Japan International Cooperation Agency, 2012–2014 (~\$50,000)

Research Experience

Texas A&M University – Department of Political Science

- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. Quan Li (Spring 2023, Spring 2022)
 - Supported research on international political economy and education.
- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. Kirby Goidel (Spring & Fall 2022)
 - Contributed to survey design and analysis on public opinion and trade.

Johns Hopkins University – SAIS, International Political Economy Program

- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. David Steinberg (Spring 2020, Fall 2019)
 - Assisted on project “[*Public Responses to Foreign Protectionism: Evidence from the U.S.–China Trade War.*](#)”

The U.S.–China Business Council

- Graduate Research Assistant for President Craig Allen (Spring 2019)
 - Researched and drafted materials for book chapter “[*U.S.-China Retrospective: Forty Years of Commercial Relations.*](#)”

Unirule Institute of Economics

- Research Assistant for Prof. Hao Jiang (Spring 2018)
 - Contributed to project “*The Dynamics of Corruption and State–Business Interactions in Chinese Local Governments.*”

Research Interests

- Economic Statecraft and Great Power Rivalry
- Development Finance, International Institutions, and Global Order
- The Political Economy of U.S.-China Relations

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record:

University at Albany, SUNY

- RPOS 102: *Comparative and International Politics*, Fall 2026
 - Incorporated group simulations to encourage teamwork, reduce reliance on AI-generated papers, and critical thinking.
- RINT 507: *Statistics for International Affairs Managers and Policy Analysts*, Spring 2027

Texas A&M University

- *POLS 429: Issues in World Politics* (Undergraduate, 35 students), Spring 2025 & Fall 2024
 - Designed and taught full course on U.S.–China relations. Incorporated group essays to encourage collaboration.

Education University of Hong Kong

- *Introduction to Stata (Online)*, Spring 2022
 - Designed and delivered an online training bootcamp course for graduate students.

Teaching Assistant:

Johns Hopkins University, SAIS

- *SA.553.106: Leadership in China* (Graduate, 45 students), Fall 2026
- *SA.553.105: Contemporary Chinese Politics* (Graduate, 36 students), Fall 2025
 - Assisted Prof. Andrew Mertha with online teaching, grading, and student support.

Texas A&M University

- *POLS 209: Political Science Research Methods* (Undergraduate, 200 students)
 - Designed and led R programming and statistics labs for two sections (25 students each).
 - Assisted with grading homework and writing assignments.
 - Worked under Profs. Ali Kagalwala (Spring 2024), Paul Kellstedt (Fall 2023), and Hyeran Jo (Fall 2021).
- *POLS 429: Issues in World Politics* (Undergraduate, 35 students), Spring 2023
 - Graded assignments and occasionally substituted for Prof. Quan Li.
- *POLS 200: Foundations of Political Science* (Undergraduate, 200 students)
 - Led discussion for two sections (25 students each).
 - Assisted with grading homework and writing assignments.
 - Worked under Profs. José Antonio Cheibub (Spring 2021) and Michelle Taylor-Robinson (Fall 2020).

Teaching Fields

- International Political Economy
- International Development
- International Institutions
- International Security
- International Relations Theory
- Comparative Political Economy
- Chinese Politics and Foreign Policy
- East Asian and Indo-Pacific Politics
- U.S.-China Relations
- Quantitative Methods

Professional Development

Mentorship

- Selected for mentorship with Miles Kahler through the APSA Mentoring Program (2025) and IHS Mentoring Program (2026).

Research Training

- Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), University of Michigan
 - *Causal Inference: An SEM Approach* (Sandy Marquart-Pyatt), 2025
 - *Regression Analysis II: Linear Models* (Timothy McDaniel), 2019
- *Advanced Topics in Liberty: Liberty, War, and Peace Colloquia*, Institute for Humane Studies, 2024
- *U.S. Foreign Policy Colloquium*, National Committee on U.S.–China Relations, 2019

Teaching Training

- **Faculty Career Fellow Program**, University at Albany, SUNY, 2026-2027
- **CIRTL Associate Fellow Certificate**, Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL), Texas A&M University, 2024
- *POLS 681: Teaching Seminar*, Texas A&M University, Spring 2024
- *Teaching & Learning Conference (TLC) at APSA*, 2024

Pre-Ph.D. Academic Programs and Field Studies

- Annual Symposium of Chinese Austrian School Economists, Taiyuan, China, 2017
- Field Study on Thai Industry and Economy, Bangkok, Thailand, 2015 (sponsored by Kyoto & Thammasat University)
- Herrenhausen Symposium, Hanover, Germany, 2015 (sponsored by Volkswagen Foundation, paper accepted but unable to attend)
- **Northeast Asia Economic Forum Young Leaders Program**, Seoul & Busan, South Korea, 2014 (sponsored by Freeman Foundation; selected as one of approximately 20–30 fellows from the United States, China, Russia, Japan, and South Korea; presented “China: The Way Ahead” on regional economic cooperation)
- IIDS–IIMS International Conference, Bonn, Germany, 2014 (sponsored by JDS Program)
- Field Study on Korean Industry and Economy, Seoul, South Korea, 2013 (sponsored by Kyoto & Seoul University)

Service

Conference Service

- **Panel Organizer**, “Economic Statecraft and Rising Power Foreign Policy,” APSA Annual Meeting, 2026.
- Discussant, Junior Scholars Symposium, Cato Institute, 2023.
- Discussant, International Studies Association (ISA) Annual Convention, 2023.

University and Department Service

Texas A&M University, Department of Political Science

- **Founding Editor-in-Chief**, *POLS Aggie Journal on the United States, China, and the World Order*, 2024–2025
- **Founding Organizer**, *Forum on the United States, China, and the World Order*, 2024–2025

Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS)

- [Editor](#), *SAIS China Studies Review*, 2018–2019
- New Cohort Consultant, 2021

Professional Memberships

- American Political Science Association (APSA)
- Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)
- International Studies Association (ISA)

Skills

Methods & Tools

- **Quantitative Analysis:** Linear and generalized linear models (OLS, MLE), Panel data and fixed effects models (TSCS), Causal inference methods (DiD, IV), Multilevel modeling, Structural equation modeling (SEM), and Survey experiments
- **Computational:** Advanced in R, Stata. Intermediate in Python, LaTeX, Web scraping, Corpus construction, Computational text analysis
- **Data Collection Platforms:** Qualtrics, Amazon Mechanical Turk (MTurk), Prolific

Languages

- **English:** Fluent (Research, Teaching, Academic Writing)
- **Chinese (Mandarin & Cantonese):** Bilingual
- **Japanese:** Basic